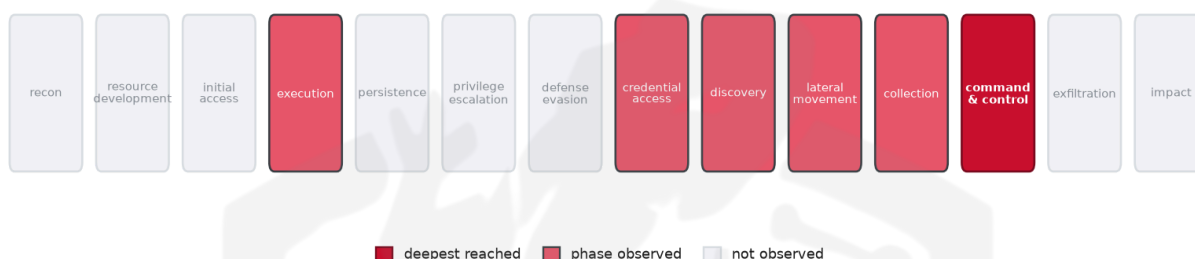


THREAT REPORT: BLACKTECH'S BLUESHELL CAMPAIGN

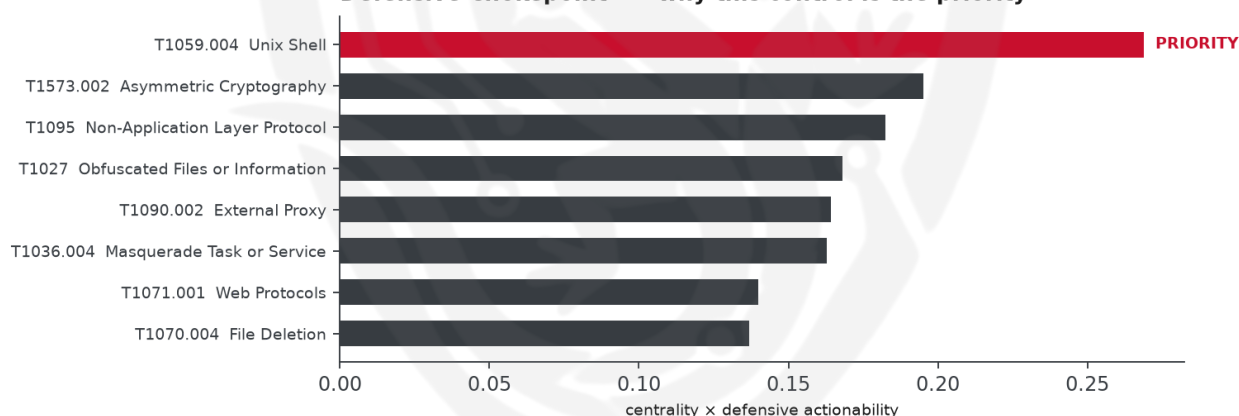
Visual Summary

Kill-Chain Reach — High (deepest phase reached: command-and-control)



How far down the attack chain this campaign reached; deepest phase in crimson.

Defensive Chokepoint — why this control is the priority



The control that most disrupts the attack (priority in crimson).

Summary

The source attributes this activity to BlackTech, who has been observed utilizing BlueShell malware variants to target countries in Southeast Asia, including Indonesia, Japan, Singapore, and Thailand. The priority defensive action should be given to constraining PowerShell for unprivileged users and enabling script-block logging to mitigate the threat. The threat actor's techniques indicate a high operational risk band, reaching command-and-control levels.

Threat Overview

BlackTech, the attributed threat actor, has been associated with the BlueShell malware family, although the central CVE exploited remains insufficient. The targeted countries include Indonesia, Japan, Singapore, and Thailand, with the threat actor employing various techniques to achieve their objectives.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The observed techniques used by the threat actor form a complex chain, including standard encoding, system checks, and system information discovery. The priority technique identified is T1059.004 Unix Shell, which serves as a critical chokepoint in the attack chain. To mitigate this threat, the priority control is to Constrain PowerShell for unprivileged users (Constrained Language Mode + AppLocker); enable script-block logging; block wscript/cscript where unneeded.

Infrastructure and Corroboration

There is no notable infrastructure or corroboration observed, with no hosting providers or ASNs identified, and no malware families corroborated by abuse.ch. Additionally, AbuseIPDB has not flagged any indicators with a confidence level of 80% or higher, with the highest confidence seen being 0%.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1132.001 Standard Encoding
- T1497.001 System Checks
- T1021.004 SSH
- T1082 System Information Discovery
- T1090.002 External Proxy
- T1083 File and Directory Discovery
- T1036.004 Masquerade Task or Service
- T1059.004 Unix Shell
- T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information
- T1573.002 Asymmetric Cryptography
- T1095 Non-Application Layer Protocol
- T1070.004 File Deletion
- T1071.001 Web Protocols
- T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer
- T1056.004 Credential API Hooking
- T1090.001 Internal Proxy

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1059.004 Unix Shell (centrality 0.3361).
- Operational risk: High (score 0.636, reaches command-and-control).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.416; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
APT18	0.416
Metador	0.4051
Velvet Ant	0.3875
Tropic Trooper	0.3669
Lazarus Group	0.3467

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 0%.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator
Hash	fdc9e765546c72841221b86fe1383c37
Hash	d7513a05ff14ee84594ec97c1defa37a1e430770
Hash	3228da011423853efd3d94ce3a28046b5ca19e921861ea5aee2700bc90fc1d55
Hash	944b774d592f5e7fe2c34ac6c3abb2a77bfa96707c4f3c33ac77b8d54800244f

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1059.004 Unix Shell (execution)
- **Observed here:** T1059.004 Unix Shell was the execution control point here; the pivot is drawn from BlackTech's own documented ATT&CK repertoire.

- **Projected pivot:** T1204 User Execution (execution)
- **Basis:** documented in BlackTech's own ATT&CK repertoire, and disproportionately paired with Unix Shell across tracked groups (lift 1.1, ~1.1x base rate). Their move, not a generic one.

The BlackTech actor could pivot to T1204 User Execution to maintain their objective by tricking users into executing malicious files or scripts, potentially through social engineering tactics or exploiting user trust, which would likely involve disguising malicious activity as legitimate tasks. This technique may be particularly appealing as it allows the adversary to bypass blocked shell access by leveraging user interactions to execute malicious code. To counter this, the mandated defensive control of blocking execution of downloaded HTA/JS/LNK, enforcing mark-of-the-web, disabling Office macros from the internet, and promoting user awareness on lures should be implemented.

Also plausible (same tactic): T1574 Hijack Execution Flow (n=32, lift 1.2), T1106 Native API (n=19, lift 1.3)

Detection and hardening for the pivot (T1204 User Execution)

- **Telemetry:** Endpoint process telemetry; Email/proxy logs
- **Detect:**
 - User double-clicking archive/ISO/LNK contents that spawn interpreters
 - Mark-of-the-Web on delivered files; LOLBIN execution from user temp paths
- **Harden:**
 - Block risky file types; ASR rules; user awareness training
 - Application control to stop execution from user-writable directories
- **MITRE:** M1049 Antivirus/Antimalware, M1038 Execution Prevention, M1017 User Training · DS0009 Process, DS0022 File